

Donning the white hat

Hacking has always been portrayed in movies as this uber complicated thing that very few individuals in the world are capable of being good at. Morpheus picked Neo, a hacker, since he was “the One”. Or you’d expect to see a whiz-kid who was naturally gifted at being “good with computers” and hence, is the world’s only hope. In the real world, things are sort of a mixed bag. A good chunk of the hackers who’ve messed around with security and intelligence agencies have actually been teenagers who’ve exploited vulnerabilities ‘for the lulz’ or perhaps did it to make a few bucks and so on. However, the vast majority of these hackers tend to be grown-ups who’re employed by governmental or security agencies to perform both offensive and defensive tests. The skill set required to be able to identify vulnerabilities and exploit them requires one to have had years of experience at dealing with such systems ... or being well-versed with a few techniques and software. That’s where this FastTrack comes in.

We’re helping you understand how black-hats (the baddies) hunt for vulnerabilities and how they go about exploiting them. This way you can execute the same steps on your own systems, preemptively so as to identify the vulnerabilities in advance and take measures to protect yourself. You don’t want a 13-year old peeping into your room by gaining access to your webcam, do you? And it’s not just yourself but even businesses could benefit with this knowledge, after all, the bigger they are, the more they stand to lose. This is why major companies such as Google, Microsoft, IBM and